

Canon i455

Born in a studio

Only the Canon i455's elder sibling overshadowed its performance in the speed tests. It's faster than a tracer bullet when printing text in both Normal as well as Best modes. As for cost-per-page, both a black as well as a colour printout will cost you around Rs 2.50—quite decent if not near-perfect.

It also does not compromise on quality. The printed text was crisp and clear, matching the ones from HP. It also reproduced minute details in



no longer...



the combi-document perfectly. It does a reasonably good job at printing photographs, but falls short of reproducing the exact tonal balance, with the yellow spectrum predominant in the output.

The Canon i455 is an entry-level SoHo inkjet printer that integrates good features and performance in a small package. The design is refreshing and cuts away from the older mould.

The steep foldable front hides a translucent plastic tray that extends to serve as an output paper tray. You need to clip the input paper tray to the back of the Canon i455. It holds 100 paper sheets. A unique feature is the presence of the new PictBridge port that lets it connect directly to a digicam sans any PC intervention. However, one can only control the preferences offered by the camera, since the printer has no controls to do so. The Canon i455 uses the two cartridge system, so if you run out of, say, yellow, you're going to have to buy a new colour cartridge.

Installation takes hardly any time—pop in the CD-ROM, install the drivers and connect the Canon i455 to the PC when prompted to do so. While printing, it displays the print job status as well as the current ink-level. The only grouse about the otherwise decent driver was its inaccurate ink-level measurement.

At Rs 7,995, the Canon i455 is way too expensive, as better models are available for less.

PictBridge

PictBridge is a technology developed by Camera and Imaging Product Association (CIPA) in Japan, to connect digital cameras and printer, eliminating the need for a PC. PictBridge ready cameras and printers can be connected over a USB interface, and images printed directly. You can tweak the settings of the image from the printer itself. Earlier, some printers could print the camera input directly, but they were compatible only with specific camera models.

Many camera and printer vendors such as HP, Epson, Lexmark and Kodak are yet to register with CIPA for the PictBridge protocol.

With PictBridge, the advantages are many. You can print images displayed on

the camera, or select a portion of an image and print it. You can also print one or multiple copies of an image, as well as define the size of the print from the printer itself, before printing it out.

Once connected to a PictBridge-compliant printer, the camera displays connection-establishment messages and also displays a progress bar when printing.

Companies such as Canon, Sony, Sanyo, Samsung, Fuji, Nikon, and Olympus have their products PictBridge-certified. Visit http://www.cipa.jp/pictbridge/CertifiedModels/PictBridgeCertifiedModels_E.html for a complete list of PictBridge-certified products. Interestingly, no American or European vendor is on that list.

Canon i455	B-
Performance	■■■■■
Features	■■■■■
Build quality	■■■■■
Value for money	■■■■■

- + Compact body and attractive design
- Expensive for its features